

without noticeable lag or stuttering. Multitasking performance is dependable, allowing multiple apps to remain active in the background without creating any major slowdowns. OnePlus has also managed to keep animations and interactions reasonably fluid, which contributes positively to the perception of speed.

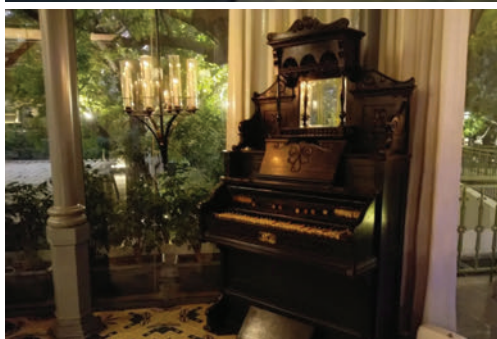
As for the benchmarks, the N6 scored 6,17,192 points on Antutu, 785 in single-core and 2,015 in multi-core Geekbench 6 performance test. In our PCMark Work 3.1, we got 7,658 points. This means you and your productivity will not be disappointed. What impressed me was the CPU throttling test. The device managed to sustain 95 per cent of its peak performance during prolonged workloads. It is an excellent result for a smartphone in this category and the cooling solution seems to be doing its job effectively.

During our gaming testing, the OnePlus N6 maintained an average of around 58.9 frames per second across gaming sessions. Touch response remains decent, and frame pacing is somewhat stable, making casual and moderate gaming reliable. As expected, the OxygenOS 16 software, with the optimisations, made the user interface smoother than I expected. Good thing? The buyers will also get 2 major OS updates and 3 years of security updates.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

Now comes arguably one of the strongest reasons to consider the OnePlus N6. The device packs a massive 8,000mAh battery, bigger than its direct competitors in the segment; in fact, the Redmi 15 and G37 Power lag behind not only in battery capacity but also in charging capabilities.

During our PCMark Battery Life test, the OnePlus N6 delivered an impressive runtime of 23 hours and 18 minutes, making it one of the best-performing smartphones we have tested in this category. For most users, that means easily



stretching through two to three full days of usage on moderate usage.

The OnePlus N6 supports 45W fast charging, which remains ahead of several rivals. In our testing, the phone charged from 0 to 100 per cent in approximately 81 minutes. Another thing that I find useful is 5W reverse charging. It allows the phone to act as a power source for small accessories- earbuds, smartwatches and other gadgets.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The OnePlus N6 has entered the most competitive segment, with a clear objective: to offer all the fundamentals that matter the most in everyday usage. At Rs 20,000, it may not have the most powerful chipset in its class, nor does it attempt to be that gimmicky photog-

raphy expert. Instead, it wants to deliver a balanced experience built around the battery life, durability, reliability and the familiar OnePlus software experience.

The biggest talking point is its 8,000 mAh battery and 45W fast charging, giving it a clear edge over the competitors in the segment. The durability aspect, including an IP65 rating and military-grade certifications, adds to that trust and will give users peace of mind.

Performance is also decent, but I expected slightly better. But this does not mean that the overall experience is not smooth and dependable. The excellent CPU throttling result and stable gaming performance indicate that OnePlus has focused on sustained usability rather than headline-grabbing benchmark numbers. The camera is also decent for the asking price.

That said, the OnePlus N6 is not without compromises. The HD+ LCD display feels less ambitious, something that I said for CE 6 Lite as well. Also, the bulky form factor may not appeal to everyone. But if your priority is battery life, durability, decent performance and camera, the OnePlus N6 makes a compelling case for itself. It may not be the most exciting smartphone in its category, but it is one of the most sensible options available for around Rs 20,000.

—Ashish Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: OxygenOS 16.0 | RAM: 4/6 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 128 GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.8-inch HD+ IPS LCD | Brightness: 3200 nits | Refresh Rate: 120Hz | Battery: 8000 mAh | Camera (Rear): 50 MP | Camera (Front): 8MP | Charging: 45W wired | Reverse Charging: 5W

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